

Matplotlib-Animation "No MovieWriters Available"

Asked 11 years, 10 months ago Modified 1 year, 4 months ago Viewed 162k times

Under Linux, I've been checking out matplotlib's animation class, and it seems to work except that I cant initialise the movie writer to write out the movie.

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Using either of the examples:

- <http://matplotlib.org/examples/animation/moviewriter.html>
- http://matplotlib.org/examples/animation/basic_example_writer.html



results in the error "**RuntimeError: No MovieWriters available!**"

Im using matplotlib version 1.3.x and have installed (hopefully) all the codecs.

Can someone please suggest as to why I get this error? If its a codecs issue, which codecs (+versions) should I install? If its something else that's broken, is there an alternative for creating animations in python?

python linux matplotlib runtime-error matplotlib-animation [Edit tags](#)

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edited May 4, 2023 at 18:19

Trenton McKinney
61.6k 41 162 180

asked Nov 9, 2012 at 21:38

Paradise
1,468 2 14 25

What OS are you running? Is ffmpeg or libav installed? – [tacaswell](#) Nov 10, 2012 at 17:55

8 `import matplotlib.animation as manimation; manimation.writers.list()` – [mimoralea](#) Aug 3, 2018 at 21:51

12 Answers

Sorted by: Date modified (newest first)

If error "MovieWriter imagemagick unavailable; using Pillow instead." pops up, try to import PillowWriter explicitly to save as mp4-File by:

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```
from matplotlib.animation import FuncAnimation, PillowWriter
```



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answered Dec 6, 2021 at 16:11

Stephan_H
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Had the same problem....managed to get it to work after a little while.

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Thing to do is follow instructions on installing FFmpeg - which is (at least on windows) a bundle of executables you need to set a path to in your environment variables



<http://www.wikihow.com/Install-FFmpeg-on-Windows>



[Download from ffmpeg.org](#)



Hope this helps someone - even after a while after the question - good luck



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edited Dec 13, 2020 at 13:55

greybeard
2,435 9 37 70

answered Jan 29, 2013 at 2:53

JPH
1,274 2 15 21

I'm running Linux. I formatted and forgot all about this question. However, to close the question, I re-installed FFmpeg and it works now (tested on Ubuntu 10.04, 10.10 and 12.04). So I would assume there was something that didn't get installed the first time around – [Paradise](#) Jan 29, 2013 at 7:57

1 Also make sure you have an up-to-date install of matplotlib. I resolved this after I updated from an older version (I was running 1.2.1). – [kjgregory](#) Dec 21, 2014 at 4:59

2 ImageMagick installer for windows will provide ffmpeg, and it's easier to install. – [RubenLaguna](#) Feb 6, 2016 at 7:44

1 FFmpeg got a new home for libraries. <https://www.ffmpeg.org/> – [Tirtha R](#) Feb 28, 2018 at 6:06

`choco install ffmpeg` works for me on windows. God bless package managers! – [A.King](#) Dec 28, 2021 at 21:24

I'm running Ubuntu 20 and I had a similar problem

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Installed ffmpeg



```
pip install ffmpeg
```



then



```
sudo apt install ffmpeg
```

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edited Oct 12, 2020 at 9:16

Fush
2,529 21 19

answered Oct 11, 2020 at 20:16

user14432237
21 1

6

I had the following error while running the cell.

[38]: HTML(anim.to_html5_video())

RuntimeError

Traceback (most recent call last)

<ipython-input-38-f885f4acf935> in <module>

----> 1 HTML(anim.to_html5_video())

~/Resources/anaconda3/envs/ml/lib/python3.7/site-packages/matplotlib/animation.py in to_html5_video(self, embed_limit)

1326 # We create a writer manually so that we can get the

1327 # appropriate size for the tag

-> 1328 Writer = writers[rcParams['animation.writer']]

1329 writer = Writer(codec='h264',

1330 bitrate=rcParams['animation.bitrate'],

~/Resources/anaconda3/envs/ml/lib/python3.7/site-packages/matplotlib/animation.py in __getitem__(self, name)

162 if self.is_available(name):

163 return self._registered[name]

--> 164 raise RuntimeError(f"Requested MovieWriter ({name}) not available")

165

166

RuntimeError: Requested MovieWriter (ffmpeg) not available

[]:

This may be due to not having `ffmpeg` in your system. Try the following command in your terminal.

```
sudo apt install ffmpeg
```

This works for me. I hope it will work out for you too.

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answered May 24, 2020 at 7:31

 Nisan Chhetri 347 3 3

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(be sure to follow JPH feedback above about the proper ffmpeg download) Not sure why, but in my case here is the one that worked (in my case was on windows).

Initialize a writer:

```
import matplotlib.pyplot as plt
import matplotlib.animation as animation
Writer = animation.FFMpegWriter(fps=30, codec='libx264') #or
Writer = animation.FFMpegWriter(fps=20, metadata=dict(artist='Me'), bitrate=1800)
==> This is WORKED FINE ^_^
```

Writer = animation.writers['ffmpeg'] ==> GIVES ERROR ""RuntimeError: Requested MovieWriter (ffmpeg) not available""

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edited Apr 18, 2019 at 23:04

answered Apr 18, 2019 at 22:55

 HassanSh_3571619 2,047 1 21 18

118

For fellow googlers using Anaconda, install the [ffmpeg](#) package:

conda install -c conda-forge ffmpeg

This works on Windows too.

(Original answer used `menpo` package owner but as mentioned by @harsh their version is a little behind at time of writing)

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edited Jul 7, 2017 at 23:33

answered Jun 11, 2017 at 11:05

 fiat 15.9k 9 86 105

worked for me too. Installed it from within Pycharm and was then able to use `Writer = animation.writers['ffmpeg']` without any further action. – Johan Jan 21, 2020 at 11:00

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I installed this but matplotlib was unable to find it. Am I missing something? – steven Jul 10, 2020 at 22:46

Is there a pip install option? – CromeX Sep 15, 2020 at 11:08

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This is gold! If not working pls try `plt.rcParams['animation.ffmpeg_path'] = 'yourhomepath/anaconda2/envs/yourenv/bin/ffmpeg'` ! – ABCMOONMAN999 Jan 4, 2021 at 4:50

This works great with Anaconda. @steven, just make sure its installed in the same environment if you have one. – Hummer Sep 11, 2021 at 23:23

7

If you are using Ubuntu 14.04 `ffmpeg` is not available. You can install it by using the instructions directly from <https://www.ffmpeg.org/download.html>.

In short you will have to:

```
sudo add-apt-repository ppa:mc3man/trusty-media
sudo apt-get update
sudo apt-get install ffmpeg gstreamer0.10-ffmpeg
```

If this does not work maybe try using `sudo apt-get dist-upgrade` but this may broke things in your system.

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edited Apr 2, 2017 at 21:07

answered Aug 13, 2016 at 17:34

https://stackoverflow.com/questions/13316397/matplotlib-animation-no-moviewriters-available

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brew install yasm
brew install ffmpeg

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answered Oct 20, 2016 at 13:05

patapouf_ai

18.5k1396135

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i tried this and made sure ffmpeg was installed. Still get the same error. – Kai Feb 24, 2017 at 16:24

@Kai is ffmpeg installed using brew ? – patapouf_ai Mar 22, 2017 at 9:44

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I am using Anaconda and conda, so I used conda install -c menpo ffmpeg=3.1.3 and I also had to: sudo ln -s /opt/local/bin/ffmpeg /usr/bin/ffmpeg and this actually worked on my macbook (10.11.2). – Kai Mar 23, 2017 at 16:37

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@patapouf_ai: yes, brew didn't work for me since I am using anaconda/conda. conda install as my comment above worked. – Kai Mar 23, 2017 at 19:41

This works for Mac OS X using python virtual environments. – Kyle Swanson Oct 5, 2018 at 14:46

14

ani.save('the_movie.mp4', writer = 'mencoder', fps=15)

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edited Apr 13, 2017 at 12:22

answered Sep 5, 2014 at 8:12

Community Bot

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Tapio

14112

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Just so people do not have to jump around in later versions of Ubuntu ffmpeg is back again (what a mess) – Heberto Mayorquin Aug 13, 2016 at 17:15

-1

This post is hidden. It was deleted 7 months ago by the post author.

Use this command pip install ffmpeg

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answered Aug 11, 2022 at 17:55

B

Baboucarr Badjie

1358

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For anyone encountering the same problem in a Windows setting, the following worked for me:

1) Install ffmpeg

2) Restart the computer.

Restarting my computer after I installed ffmpeg was essential, otherwise it does not work.

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edited Jan 16, 2020 at 22:30

answered Aug 29, 2016 at 12:23

patapouf_ai

18.5k1396135

Fiona

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This does not really answer the question. If you have a different question, you can ask it by clicking Ask Question. You can also add a bounty to draw more attention to this question once you have enough reputation. - From Review – J. Chomel Aug 29, 2016 at 12:39

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A solution that should work for both Windows and Linux is:

step one: download and unzip ffmpeg. and say that path_ffmpeg is the path to the ffmpeg executable (for example in windows it could be something like "path/ffmpeg/bin/ffmpeg.exe"

step two:

ffmpegpath = os.path.abspath(path_ffmpeg)
matplotlib.rcParams["animation.ffmpeg_path"] = ffmpegpath
writer = animation.FFMpegWriter()
anim.save(fname,writer = writer)

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edited Jan 16, 2020 at 22:25

answered May 29, 2019 at 2:42

https://stackoverflow.com/questions/13316397/matplotlib-animation-no-moviewriters-available

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patapouf_ai

18.5k1396135



Sailist

1649

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The question is tagged with Linux. – Gino Mempin May 29, 2019 at 4:32
- 

looks that it would work in Linux too if the .exe suffix is removed. – Jean-François Fabre ♦ May 29, 2019 at 5:29

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